

AMERICAN SELF STORAGE · NORTH CAROLINA

Marketing Voice & Style Guide

The authoritative guide to how American Self Storage sounds — in a text, in an email, on a sign, and in the reply to a two-star review. One voice, eleven regions, zero corporate-speak.

Version 1.0 · July 2026 · For managers, marketers, and anyone writing on our behalf

QUICK REFERENCE

The Voice at a Glance

If you read nothing else, read this. Our voice in one line: **a real local manager who's nice, efficient, and proud of a clean property — talking to you like a neighbor, not a customer.**

PERSONALITY

Neighborly & warm, with a witty, memorable streak

THE FEELING WE LEAVE BEHIND

“I can trust these folks.”

WHO'S TALKING

The local manager, first person: “I,” not “we”

REGISTER

Conversational, personal, direct — most casual in SMS

HUMOR

Self-aware honesty + relatable life-moment humor. No puns.

ON PRICE

Value over price. Sell the property and the person, not the discount.

VOICE MODELS

SIGNATURE

Scooter's Coffee nice ×
Costco efficient

First name + role: “—
Dana, Property Manager”

The two-word test: before anything ships, ask — is it **nice**, and is it **efficient**? Nice means a human wrote it and a human would enjoy receiving it. Efficient means it respects the reader's time: the point comes early, the next step is obvious, and nothing is padded. Copy that's only nice rambles. Copy that's only efficient feels like a robot. We're both, every time.

SECTION 1

Brand Foundation

Who we are

American Self Storage is a locally owned and operated self-storage company serving eleven regions across North Carolina. Our customers are our neighbors: families between houses, small businesses that outgrew the back room, retirees downsizing, students between semesters. Storage is rarely anyone's happy errand — people show up mid-move, mid-renovation, mid-life-change. Our marketing meets them there: helpfully, warmly, and without wasting their time.

Everything we publish is aimed at **renters** — the people who trust us with their things. This guide governs every word we put in front of them: texts, emails, review replies, social posts, website copy, and the sign by the road.

The internal north star

INTERNAL TAGLINE — NEVER CUSTOMER-FACING

“Exceptional service, profitably.”

This is our operating compass, not a slogan for the gate. For marketing, it means two things: we promise the level of service we can actually sustain, and we don't buy affection with gimmicks we'd have to claw back later. Warmth we can afford to keep is the only warmth worth advertising.

The feeling we're building

Every piece of marketing has one job above all others: leave the reader thinking *"I can trust these folks."* Trust is the product. A storage unit is a promise that someone's belongings — the crib, the business inventory, Grandma's dining table — will be exactly as they left them, in a clean, lit, looked-after place, with a real person nearby who cares. Copy earns trust the same way a manager does at the counter: by being specific, honest, and unhurried about the sell.

Personality: neighborly, with a wink

Our personality is **neighborly & warm** first, **witty & memorable** second — in that order. The warmth is the foundation; the wit is what makes us stick in memory in a category full of beige. When the two are ever in tension, warmth wins.

WE ARE

The manager who remembers your name and which unit is yours. Helpful before clever. Funny the way a good neighbor is funny — about life, moving chaos, and the fact that storage isn't glamorous.

WE ARE NOT

A corporation doing "friendly." A pun machine. A too-cool internet brand chasing trends. A discount warehouse shouting about deals. Anyone who says "state-of-the-art" out loud.

Voice models: Scooter's × Costco

Two brands, neither of them storage, triangulate our voice. **Scooter's Coffee** brings the nice: genuinely upbeat people, fast and consistent, happy you showed up. **Costco** brings the efficient: no frills, no oversell, deep trust earned by simply being good at the job and not playing games. Blend them and you get us — *nice + efficient*. Warm at the window, ruthless about wasted words.

SECTION 2

The Four Voice Pillars

Four rules produce the voice. If a draft honors all four, it will sound like us — even if you've never written for us before.

Pillar 1 — A person, not a company

The voice belongs to the **local property manager, speaking as “I.”** Not “we,” not “the management,” not “American Self Storage is pleased to announce.” One human being, with a name and a role, who works at that property and answers that phone. This is the single most important rule in this guide, because it's the one thing the big operators can't copy.

SOUNDS LIKE US

“I'll leave the lock in the office for you — just ask for me at the window.”

“I walk the rows every morning. If something's off with your unit, I'll usually spot it before you do.”

DOESN'T

“Management will provide a lock at the time of rental.”

“We pride ourselves on facility standards that exceed expectations.”

Where “we” is allowed: brand-level surfaces that no single manager owns — taglines, the road sign, a website headline about all eleven regions. Everywhere a message could plausibly come from a person, it must come from a person.

Pillar 2 — Say it straight

Conversational, personal, **direct**. The important thing goes in the first sentence. Sentences stay short. Claims stay specific. If a word exists only to impress, cut it; if a fact would help the reader decide, add it. Directness is a form of respect — and respect is how trust starts.

SOUNDS LIKE US

“A 10x10 fits a two-bedroom apartment, give or take a couch. Come look at one — takes five minutes.”

DOESN'T

“Our diverse array of unit sizes offers flexible solutions for all your storage needs.”

Pillar 3 — Warm, with a wink

Humor is our seasoning, never the meal. The two flavors we use — self-aware honesty and relatable life-moment humor — are defined fully in [Section 3](#). The short version:

we're allowed to be funny about storage being unglamorous and about the chaos of moving. We are never funny at the customer's expense, and never in a hard message.

Pillar 4 — Earn trust, don't demand it

We sell **value over price**. Copy leads with the clean, lit, cared-for property and the real person running it — not with a dollar figure. No fake urgency, no countdown timers, no asterisks doing dirty work. When we mention price, it's plainly and confidently, as a fact rather than a hook. If inventory really is tight, say so plainly — true scarcity stated honestly (“fair warning: I've got two 10x20s left”) is information, not pressure.

SECTION 3

Humor: The Wink

Wit is what makes us memorable, so it's worth defining precisely. We use exactly two flavors — and we skip the two everyone expects from a storage company.

Flavor 1 — Self-aware honesty

We know what we sell. It's a clean, secure, well-lit room with a roll-up door — and we think doing that *extremely well* is worth being proud of. Humor that admits storage isn't glamorous, then takes obvious pride in the details anyway, is our sweet spot. It disarms people, and it's honest, which loops straight back to trust.

SOUNDS LIKE US

“It's a garage. But it's an immaculate garage, the lights all work, and I know your name. That's the whole pitch.”

“Nobody dreams of renting a storage unit. But if the day comes, you might as well rent one from somebody who sweeps.”

Flavor 2 — Situational & relatable

Life-moment humor: the move that took “one more trip” six times, the garage the car hasn't seen in years, the in-laws arriving in nine days, the small business drowning in

inventory. This humor works because it's about *the situation the reader is actually in* — it says “I've seen this a hundred times, you're in good hands.”

SOUNDS LIKE US

“No one in recorded history has finished a move in one trip. When the garage stops closing, I've got a clean 10x10 with your name on it.”

“Renovation rule of thumb: everything takes twice as long and the couch has nowhere to go. I can help with exactly one of those.”

What we don't do

- **No puns or wordplay.** No “space” jokes, no “lock in this deal,” no “store more, stress less.” Puns are the default register of storage marketing, which is exactly why we don't use them.
- **Never at the customer's expense.** We joke about situations, never about people, their belongings, or their circumstances. A divorce, a downsizing, an estate cleanout — these bring people to our gates, and they get zero comedy.
- **Humor switches off in hard messages.** Past a first friendly payment nudge, the wink is gone entirely (see [Section 9](#)).
- **If in doubt, leave it out.** A warm message with no joke is always on-brand. A joke that might land wrong never is.

SECTION 4

Tone Dials by Situation

One voice, adjustable tone. The person speaking never changes — how much warmth, wit, and formality they bring depends on the moment.

SITUATION	WARMTH	WIT	EXCLAMATION POINTS	NOTES
Promos & social posts	High	Welcome	Yes — earned, one at a time	Our most personality-forward writing. Still specific, still true.

Welcome & how-to (move-in, gate codes, FAQs)	High	Light	Sparingly	Clarity outranks charm. Warmth shows up as anticipating questions.
Service recovery (complaints, review replies)	High	Off*	No	Own it, fix it, sign it. (*A light touch is permissible only for clearly minor gripes.)
Money — first nudge	Warm	Off	One, softening	Assume good faith. Cards expire; life happens.
Money — escalated	Courteous	Off	No	Plain, factual, respectful. Formality rises with severity (Section 9).
Rate changes & legal notices	Courteous	Off	No	The news in the first sentence. No burying, no cushioning into vagueness.

SECTION 5

Style Mechanics

Point of view

- **First person singular, always**, wherever a message could come from a person: SMS, email, review replies, social posts, GBP updates. “I” is the manager of that property.
- **“We” only on brand-level surfaces** — taglines, signage, all-locations website copy — where no single manager is speaking.
- **“You” is the reader**, addressed directly and often. Never “customers,” “tenants,” or “valued clients” in copy aimed at them.

Punctuation & emoji

- **Exclamation points are part of the warmth — use them.** Where a friendly person would sound pleased, sound pleased. Guardrails: one at a time (never “!!”), not on

every sentence, and switched off entirely in escalated money messages, legal notices, and serious complaint replies.

- **Emoji: sparingly.** At most one per message, only in SMS and social, only common and universally readable ones (📦 🔑 👍 🎉). Never in email body copy, website copy, review replies, or anything operational or hard. If the words already carry the warmth, skip it.
- **Everything else stays calm:** no ALL-CAPS for emphasis, no ellipses trailing off, sentence case for headlines. Dashes and contractions are welcome — we write like people talk.

Length

- **SMS: short and punchy, no exceptions.** One to three sentences. If it needs a paragraph, it's an email.
- **Everywhere else: room to be human.** Short by default, but a three-or-four-sentence personal note is welcome when it earns its length. The test isn't word count — it's whether every sentence is doing work.
- **Headlines and signage: eight words or fewer,** and the first three carry the meaning.

The CTA formula

Every call to action is a **clear, direct ask + a helpful next step**. Say exactly what to do, then make it feel easy — tell them how long it takes, offer to do it for them, or hand them the link. Never vague (“learn more”), never pushy (“act now”).

ON FORMULA

“Reserve your unit today — it's about two minutes online, or call me and I'll handle it.”

“Come take a look this week. I'm here til 6, and it'll take five minutes.”

OFF FORMULA

“Don't miss this opportunity — contact us today to learn more about our storage solutions!”

“Click here.”

Signatures

The standard sign-off is **first name + role**: “— Dana, Property Manager.” It appears on SMS, emails, review replies, and social/GBP posts. In email, the signature block adds the

property line beneath: name and role, then “American Self Storage – Concord” and the direct phone number. Within a live back-and-forth thread where you've already signed once, first name alone is fine.

Naming conventions

- First reference: **American Self Storage**. In flowing copy thereafter, **“American”** is acceptable shorthand.
- **Never abbreviate the name to its initials.** No exceptions — not in copy, not in file names, not on signage. If you're unsure why, say the initials out loud.
- Locations are referred to by region: “American Self Storage – Clayton,” or in conversation, “the Clayton property.”

SECTION 6

Language: Use / Avoid

Four categories of language are banned outright, one is regulated, and industry terms get translated. This section is the law; the rewrite gallery in [Section 12](#) shows it applied.

Banned: corporate puffery

“State-of-the-art,” “premier,” “world-class,” “luxury storage,” “unparalleled,” “best-in-class,” “exceeds expectations.” These words are what companies say when they have nothing specific to offer. We always have something specific to offer, so we say that instead.

INSTEAD

“Paved lot, LED lights on every row, cameras that actually get checked, and a manager on site six days a week.”

BANNED

“A premier, state-of-the-art facility with unparalleled security features.”

Banned: pressure tactics

“Act now!” “Don’t miss out!” “Limited time only!” — fake urgency, countdown energy, and manufactured scarcity are all off-limits. They’re the opposite of “I can trust these folks.” The one exception isn’t really an exception: **true scarcity, stated plainly, is honest information.** “Fair warning — I’ve only got two 10x20s left this month” is fine, because it’s a fact delivered like a fact.

Banned: robot jargon

Industry terms are fine as *labels* — people search for “climate-controlled” and we should say it. What’s banned is letting jargon do the *selling*. Every industry term that matters to the decision gets a plain-English translation the first time it appears.

INDUSTRY TERM	HOW WE TRANSLATE IT
Climate-controlled	“Climate-controlled — heated and cooled year-round, so think closet, not garage.”
Drive-up access	“Drive-up — back your car right up to your own door.”
Roll-up door	“A garage-style door you can open with one hand, even with a box in the other.”
Gated access / keypad entry	“Your own gate code, and the gate actually closes behind you.”
10x10, 10x20, unit sizes	Always anchor to life: “a 10x10 holds a two-bedroom apartment, give or take a couch.”

Regulated: slang

Slang is allowed when it’s **broadly relatable** — words a large group of people across ages would use without thinking: “no sweat,” “heads up,” “a ton of room,” “the good ones.” What’s off-brand is **cutting-edge or narrow slang** — anything very new, very online, or belonging to one small group. If it would need explaining to anyone at the counter, it doesn’t ship. (“Hey fam,” “vibes,” “no cap,” “it’s giving” — all out.)

Words we lean on

Clean. Well-lit. Looked after. Swept. Straightforward. Come by. Take a look. I'll handle it. Give me a call. Happy to. Right up to your door. Good hands. These are our load-bearing words — plain, physical, and verifiable on a walk through the property.

SECTION 7

What We Sell: The Two Messaging Pillars

Every piece of marketing advances one or both of these. If a draft advances neither, it doesn't ship.

Pillar A — A real person, local

Locally owned, locally managed, and when you call, a human who knows the property answers. This is the moat. The national operators have call centers and kiosks; we have Dana, who walks the rows every morning and will leave the cart out if you're coming after work. Copy makes this concrete: name the manager, mention the direct line, describe things only an on-site human would know.

IN PRACTICE

"Call the Durham office and you'll get me — not a call center. I can usually tell you which unit to take before you've finished describing what's going in it."

Pillar B — Clean, safe, cared-for

Well-lit, secure, and genuinely spotless — a property someone is visibly proud of. We prove it with specifics, not adjectives: the restriped lot, the new LEDs on Row C, the morning walk-through, the swept corridors. Pride in upkeep is our version of a security promise, and it photographs well too.

IN PRACTICE

"If the unit isn't spotless when you first roll up that door, call me and I'll make it right that day."

Where price fits

Beneath both pillars, never above them. We're value-over-price: the story is what you get, and the rate is a plain fact stated with confidence near the decision point. We don't lead ads with dollar signs, we don't do teaser-rate theater, and we don't apologize for what good costs. When a prospect pushes on a cheaper competitor, the voice stays gracious: "They're a fine option. Come walk both properties and pick the one you'd want your mother's furniture in."

SECTION 8

Channel Playbooks

Same voice, tuned per channel. Formality rises slightly from SMS → social → email → website; the person speaking never changes.

SMS — the most casual we get

- One to three sentences. Short and punchy is the law here.
- Open with who you are on first contact: "It's Dana at American Self Storage."
- One idea, one ask, one link max. Sign off first name + role.
- Reads like a text from a neighbor who happens to manage the place.

SMS

Hey Sarah — it's Dana at American Self Storage. A few 10x10s just opened up near the gate, and they're the good ones. Want me to hold one for you? — Dana, Property Manager

Promo SMS: personal, specific, true, zero pressure.

SMS

Morning! Your unit's ready — B14, gate code ends in #. Carts are by the main door, grab one anytime. Anything looks off, text me right here. — Dana, Property Manager

Move-in day SMS: warmth through usefulness.

Email — conversational, room to be human

- Subject lines: plain, specific, under ~7 words, no bait. “You're all set — unit B14” beats “Welcome to the family!!”
- Body: greet by name, the point in the first sentence, then whatever genuinely helps. Three or four short paragraphs is the ceiling for most messages.
- One CTA per email, in the clear-ask + easy-next-step formula.
- Signature block: first name + role, then property and direct phone.

Subject: You're all set — unit B14

Hi Sarah,

Dana here at American Self Storage in Concord — your 10x10 is ready. Gate code's in your welcome packet, and the flatbed carts live just inside the main door. Take whichever one's least squeaky.

One promise before you load a single box: if that unit isn't spotless when you first roll up the door, call me and I'll make it right that day.

Moving's a beast. Holler if I can make any part of it easier!

Dana

Property Manager

American Self Storage – Concord · (XXX) XXX-XXXX

Google Business Profile & reviews — often our first impression

GBP posts are short, concrete, and property-proud: what got fixed, cleaned, upgraded, or restriped this month, signed by the manager. They exist to show the property is looked after by someone real.

Review replies follow one rule: own it, fix it, sign it.

- **Own it:** respond as “I,” by name, with zero defensiveness. If we were wrong, say so in the first sentence. No “we apologize for any inconvenience” — that phrase is banned.
- **Fix it:** say specifically what you did or will do, with a timeframe where possible.
- **Sign it:** first name + role, plus the direct phone number so it can move offline.
- Positive reviews get real replies too — short, specific to what they mentioned, never copy-paste.

- A light touch is allowed only when the gripe is clearly minor and the reviewer is clearly good-humored. When in doubt, warm and straight.

TWO-STAR REVIEW, OUR REPLY

"You're right, and I'm sorry — the gate shouldn't have been down twice in one week. The tech replaced the motor Tuesday and I've tested it every morning since. If it gives you any trouble at all, call me directly: (XXX) XXX-XXXX. — Dana, Property Manager"

NEVER THIS

"We apologize for any inconvenience you may have experienced. Customer satisfaction is our top priority. Please contact our office during regular business hours to discuss further."

Social media — community first, promos second

- The feed is the property's life: upkeep in progress, seasonal moving-chaos humor, local happenings, the occasional plain-spoken promo.
- Manager-voice "I" posts, signed with name and town, so followers know which property is talking.
- This is where the wink lives most comfortably — self-aware and situational humor per Section 3. Still no puns.
- Photos of real details beat stock photography every single time: the swept corridor, the new lights, the flatbed carts lined up.

Example post (Pittsboro):

"No one in recorded history has finished a move in one trip. Not once. When the garage stops closing, I've got a clean 10x10 waiting — come by and I'll show you the good ones. — Mike, Property Manager"

Website & signage — the brand-level surfaces

- The website is where "we" may speak for all eleven regions — but each location page hands the mic back to its manager by name, with a photo if we have a decent one.
- Unit descriptions anchor sizes to real life and translate every industry term (Section 6 table).

- FAQs are written exactly as the manager would answer at the counter — first person, direct, no legalese where plain words will do.
- Signage: eight words or fewer, warm and plain. “Clean units. A manager who answers.” beats any sentence with “premier” in it.

SECTION 9

Hard Messages, Tiered by Severity

Money and legal messages follow a ladder: the friendlier rungs sound like a neighbor's nudge, and each escalation gets more formal — never colder in spirit, just more precise. Humor is off past Tier 1. Exclamation points are off past Tier 1. The facts always come first.

TIER	SITUATION	REGISTER	SIGNATURE
Tier 1	First late notice, failed autopay, gentle heads-up	Warm, casual, assumes good faith. One softening exclamation point allowed.	First name + role
Tier 2	Meaningfully past due, second/third notice	Courteous and plain. Consequences stated as facts with dates. Options offered.	First name + role + property
Tier 3	Final notice, lien process, legal requirements	Formal, precise, compliant. Full sentences, exact dates and amounts, statutory language where required — still written by a human, still respectful.	Full name + role + property + phone

TIER 1 — THE FRIENDLY NUDGE

SMS

Hey Sarah — it's Dana at American Self Storage. Looks like July's payment didn't go through (cards expire, it happens!). Here's the link to update it, or call me and I'll sort it out in two minutes. — Dana, Property Manager

TIER 2 — COURTEOUS AND CLEAR

Subject: Unit B14 — payment 15 days past due

Hi Sarah,

Your unit is now 15 days past due, with a balance of \$128. I have to apply a late fee on the 20th and restrict gate access until the account is current — I'd much rather not do either.

You can pay online here, or call me and we'll figure it out together. If something's going on, tell me — I have more options than you'd think.

Dana

Property Manager, American Self Storage – Concord · (XXX) XXX-XXXX

TIER 3 — FORMAL AND EXACT

Final and lien-stage notices follow the statutory requirements to the letter: full legal names, unit number, itemized balance, exact deadlines, and required disclosures. The voice contribution at this tier is precision and dignity — no boilerplate coldness beyond what the law requires, a real signature, and a phone number that reaches a person until the last possible day.

RATE CHANGES

Rate-change notices are Tier 2 register regardless of amount: the news and the effective date in the first sentence, the new rate stated plainly, a sentence on what their rate supports (the upkeep they can see), and an invitation to call. No burying the number, no “exciting updates to your account,” no humor.

SECTION 10

Local Flavor: Writing Like North Carolina

Eleven regions, one rule: sound like you're from there, because we are.

Harrisburg

Concord

High Point

Durham

Pittsboro

Chapel Hill

Sanford

Fuquay-Varina

Clayton

Knightdale

Zebulon

- **Name the town.** “Here in Fuquay” beats “in your area” every time. Managers write like residents, not like a chain with local branches.

- **Reference real local life** where it's natural: the fair coming through, Friday night games, festival weekends, the new roundabout everyone has opinions about. One authentic local touch per message is plenty.
- **College loyalties: playful neutrality.** Several of our towns bleed different shades of blue. We love the rivalry, we never pick a side: “Every unit here is neutral territory — Carolina blue and Duke blue store side by side in peace.”
- **Weather is shared ground.** Humidity, hurricane season, the one week of snow chaos — relatable, seasonal, and a natural reason to mention climate-controlled units without robot-speak.
- **Never fake it.** A generic message with no local reference is fine. A wrong or forced local reference (“Howdy, y'all!” from someone who's clearly never been to Zebulon) is off-brand.

SECTION 11

Taglines

Internal: *“Exceptional service, profitably”* is our operating compass and stays internal — it guides decisions, it never appears on customer-facing material.

Customer-facing candidates. No public tagline is locked yet. The following are on-voice options for consideration — each is plain, warm, specific to our two pillars, and pun-free. (Taglines are a brand-level surface, so “we” is permitted here.)

1 **“Storage with a real person behind it.”** — Pillar A distilled. Works on signage, holds up in radio.

2 **“Clean units. Straight answers.”** — Both pillars, five words, sounds like Costco raised in North Carolina.

3 **“Come see the difference a real manager makes.”** — Invitation-shaped, points straight at the moat.

4 **“It's just storage. We just do it right.”** — Self-aware honesty, flavor 1, in tagline form.

5 “Looked after like it's ours.” — The trust promise in six syllables; pairs well under the logo.

SECTION 12

Rewrite Gallery: Before & After

The whole guide applied. Left is the industry default; right is us.

WEBSITE HERO

BEFORE

“Welcome to the premier state-of-the-art storage facility offering unparalleled security and world-class customer service for all your storage needs.”

AFTER

“Clean, well-lit storage in Clayton — with a manager who actually answers the phone. Come take a look; it'll take five minutes. — Dana, Property Manager”

PROMO SMS

BEFORE

“🔔🔥 HUGE SAVINGS!! Act NOW — units are going FAST! Don't miss out on our LIMITED TIME offer!!! Click here!”

AFTER

“It's Dana at American Self Storage. Fair warning — I'm down to two 10x20s this month, and they're the drive-up ones. Want me to hold one? — Dana, Property Manager”

UNIT DESCRIPTION

BEFORE

“10x10 climate-controlled unit featuring roll-up door and 24/7 gated keypad access. Perfect solution for your storage needs.”

AFTER

“A 10x10 holds a two-bedroom apartment, give or take a couch. This one's climate-controlled — heated and cooled year-round, closet not garage — with a garage-style door you can lift one-handed and your own gate code.”

RATE INCREASE NOTICE

BEFORE

"Please be advised that pursuant to your rental agreement, your monthly rate will be adjusted effective the first of next month. We appreciate your continued business and remain committed to providing exceptional service."

AFTER

"Hi Sarah — starting September 1, your unit's rate goes from \$95 to \$103 a month. I never love sending these, so here's what it pays for: the new LED lighting on your row, the resealed lot, and a property that gets walked every morning. Questions, or want to talk options? Call me directly. — Dana, Property Manager"

HOLIDAY HOURS POST**BEFORE**

"Please note our office will be closed Thursday in observance of the holiday. Normal business operations will resume Friday. We apologize for any inconvenience."

AFTER

"Office is closed Thursday for Thanksgiving — gate access is unchanged, so come and go as usual. I'm back Friday morning, probably still full of stuffing. Happy Thanksgiving! — Dana, Property Manager"

SECTION 13

The Pre-Send Checklist

Eight questions before anything ships. All eight, every time — it takes about a minute.

- 1 Would I say this out loud to a tenant at the counter?** If it would sound stiff or salesy spoken, rewrite it.
- 2 Is a real "I" behind it?** First-person manager voice, signed first name + role (unless it's a brand-level surface).
- 3 Is the important thing in the first sentence?** No warm-up laps, no buried news.
- 4 Is every claim specific and true?** No puffery, no fake urgency, nothing you couldn't prove on a walk through the property.

- 5 **If there's humor — is it self-aware or situational, never at the customer, and is this a moment where humor belongs at all?** Hard messages past Tier 1: humor off.
- 6 **Is the next step a clear ask made easy?** One CTA, with the friction removed.
- 7 **Channel check:** SMS at three sentences or fewer? Email earning its length? Signage under eight words? Emoji at most one, and only where allowed?
- 8 **The two-word test: is it nice, AND is it efficient?** If it's only one of the two, it isn't done.

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Maintained by ownership. When this guide and instinct disagree, follow the guide — then tell us, and we'll fix one or the other.